

Hikaru Asano

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Education

The University of Tokyo Doctoral Student in Graduate School of Arts and Sciences • <i>Supervisor:</i> Yukino Baba	Apr 2024 – Present
The University of Tokyo Master of Interdisciplinary Information Studies in Graduate School of Interdisciplinary Information Studies • <i>Supervisor:</i> Osamu Sakura	Apr 2022 – Mar 2024
The University of Tokyo Bachelor of Engineering in Systems Innovation, Faculty of Engineering • <i>Supervisor:</i> Takashi Goda	Apr 2019 – Mar 2022

Research Experience

Sakana AI , Tokyo, Japan Research Intern	Apr 2026 – Present
Omron SINIC X Corporation , Tokyo, Japan Research Intern	Dec 2025 – Mar 2026
CyberAgent AI Lab , Tokyo, Japan Part-time Researcher	Oct 2023 – Oct 2025
OMRON SINIC X Corporation , Tokyo, Japan Research Intern	Mar 2022 – Aug 2023
OMRON SINIC X Corporation , Tokyo, Japan Research Intern	Aug 2020 – Sep 2020

Publications

International Conference (Peer-Reviewed)

- **Hikaru Asano**, Hiroki Ouchi, Akira Kasuga, Ryo Yonetani
“MobQA: A Benchmark Dataset for Semantic Understanding of Human Mobility Data through Question Answering”
The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2026
Acceptance rate: 15.4%
[arXiv](#) [Code](#)
- **Hikaru Asano**, Tadashi Kozuno, Yukino Baba
“Self Iterative Label Refinement via Robust Unlabeled Learning”
The Thirty-Ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2025
Poster presentation | Acceptance rate: 24.5%
[arXiv](#) [Code](#)
- **Hikaru Asano**, Hiroki Ouchi, Taiki Sekii, Ryo Yonetani
“Text2Traj2Text: Learning-by-Synthesis Framework for Contextual Captioning of Human Movement Trajectories”
International Natural Language Generation Conference (INLG), 2024
Long paper
[arXiv](#) [Code](#)
- Eiko Matsuda, **Hikaru Asano**, Tomoyuki Yuzawa, Osamu Sakura
“Quantitative and Qualitative Analyses on Child’s Animate Tendency”

Cognitive feelings: Towards multi-disciplinary approaches for realizing artificial systems with cognitive capacities (ALIFE 2023 workshop), 2023

- **Hikaru Asano**, Osamu Sakura
“Rashomon Bound Regression: a Reproducible and Explorable Method for Regression-Based Analysis”
International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), 2023
[Poster presentation](#)
- **Hikaru Asano**, Ryo Yonetani, Mai Nishimura, Tadashi Kozuno
“Counterfactual Fairness Filter for Fair-Delay Multi-Robot Navigation”
International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (AAMAS), 2023
[Oral presentation](#) | [Acceptance rate: 23.3%](#)
[arXiv](#) [Code](#)

Preprint

- **Hikaru Asano**, Tadashi Kozuno, Kuniaki Saito, Yukino Baba
“Where-to-Unmask: Ground-Truth-Guided Unmasking Order Learning for Masked Diffusion Language Models”
arXiv preprint, 2026
[arXiv](#)
- **Hikaru Asano**
“Sequential Bayesian experimental designs via reinforcement learning”
arXiv preprint, 2022
[arXiv](#)

Patent

- Ryo Yonetani, Mai Nishimura Kurose, **Hikaru Asano**
“Agent Control Device, Learning Device, and Computer-Readable Recording Medium”
US Patent App. 18/241,146

Awards and Honors

Scholarships and Grants

- **KAKUSEI Project by AIST**
3,000,000 yen (salary and research expenses), 2026.
- **Research RA in Value Exchange Engineering by RIISE@UTokyo**
2,000,000 yen, 2023-2024.
- **The foundation Matsuo Scholarship Society**
Scholarship and commuting expenses grant, free accommodation in student dormitories, provision of meals (free), health insurance expenses grant, total amount granted: approximately 5,000,000 yen, 2019-2023.

Academic Awards

- **Young Researcher Award (21/517)**
The 32nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing@Japan, 2026.
- **Hatakeyama Prize**
Tomakomai National Institute of Technology, 2019.

Languages

- **Japanese:** Native
- **English:** TOEFL iBT MyBest Score: 104

Programming Skills

- **Python:** PyTorch, Jax, Transformers, TRL, Ray
- **Others:** C++